NexaPair × KAYAK STRATEGIC ADVISORS

READINESS CHECKLIST



TPRM TOOLKIT · NOVEMBER 2026

Article 13 readiness checklist

Nineteen requirements of CBUAE Regulation C 1/2026, each with a readiness question, the evidence to keep and a suggested owner.

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Readiness is a matter of evidence: each row names the record that proves it. Photo: Pexels.

STATUS KEY

- ☐ Not started
- ☐ In progress
- ☐ Done: evidence filed
- ☐ N/A: record why

ABOUT THIS CHECKLIST

How to use the checklist

Work through the rows with each owner, tick a status, name the person and set a target date. Then score your readiness on the summary page.

1. **Assign owners.** Use the suggested owner as a starting point and write a named person, not a department.
2. **Find the evidence.** A requirement is only “Done” when the evidence in column 4 is filed and dated.
3. **Set dates.** Give every open row a target date inside the next two quarters.
4. **Score.** Count statuses per stage on the summary page; readiness is Done ÷ applicable.
5. **Report.** Take the summary to the risk committee and refresh it monthly.

SPREADSHEET VERSION

The Excel edition of this checklist has drop-down statuses and calculates readiness for you: NexaPair-Article-13-Readiness-Checklist.xlsx on nexapair.ae/resources.

NOT LEGAL ADVICE

Requirements are paraphrased. Check the official text in the CBUAE Rulebook before relying on them.

CHECKLIST · STAGE 1

Ref	Requirement (paraphrased)	Readiness question	Evidence to keep	Suggested owner	Status	Owner (name)	Target date
GOVERN							
4.1–4.2	The Board is responsible for operational risk, including outsourced activities.	**Does the Board receive regular reporting on third-party risk?**	Board minutes; Board pack	Board, CRO	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
3.4	Map Critical Operations, including the third parties that support them.	**Can you name the providers behind each Critical Operation?**	Critical Operations map	Operations, Risk	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
8.9	Keep the master system of record in the UAE, including where outsourced.	**Is the data location of every material provider recorded?**	Data-location register; contract clauses	IT, Legal	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.1	Board-approved third-party risk strategy and policy.	**Has the Board approved the policy in the last 12 months?**	Approved policy; risk appetite; tiering method	Risk	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.2	Avoid over-reliance on outsourcing.	**Do you report concentration and single-source dependencies?**	Concentration analysis	Risk, Procurement	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		

START HERE

Governance comes first: without a Board-approved policy and a Critical Operations map, the other stages have nothing to measure against.

CHECKLIST · STAGE 2

Ref	Requirement (paraphrased)	Readiness question	Evidence to keep	Suggested owner	Status	Owner (name)	Target date
SELECT AND CONTRACT							
13.3	Risk assessment and due diligence before engagement.	**Is due diligence always complete before signature, by tier?**	Tiering result; due diligence file	Procurement, Compliance	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.4	Equivalent operational resilience for providers of Critical Operations.	**Are critical providers within your disruption tolerances?**	Recovery objectives vs tolerances; tests	Operations, IT	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.5	Central Bank non-objection before outsourcing affecting Critical Operations.	**Is non-objection on file before every relevant go-live?**	Non-objection letters; onboarding gate	Compliance	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.6	Written contracts: rights, data ownership, confidentiality, termination, audit.	**Do all material contracts include these terms?**	Clause checklist per contract	Legal	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.7	Central Bank access to providers, including on-site examination.	**Does every relevant contract grant Central Bank access?**	Access clause	Legal	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.8	Subcontractors bound by the same terms.	**Are flow-down clauses in place for material subcontractors?**	Flow-down clauses; subcontractor register	Legal, Procurement	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		

CHECKLIST · STAGE 3

Ref	Requirement (paraphrased)	Readiness question	Evidence to keep	Suggested owner	Status	Owner (name)	Target date
MONITOR							
13.9.1	Register of outsourced activities.	**Is the register complete and current today?**	Register (NexaPair workbook)	Procurement	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.9.2	Performance metrics for outsourced activities.	**Are service levels measured and reviewed?**	SLA reports; performance reviews	Business owners	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.9.3	Ongoing assessment, including financial condition.	**Are providers re-screened and financially monitored?**	Monitoring alerts; financial reviews	Risk, Compliance	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.9.4	Dependency management.	**Are dependencies and related parties analysed?**	Relationship and dependency analysis	Risk	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		

CHECKLIST · STAGE 4

Ref	Requirement (paraphrased)	Readiness question	Evidence to keep	Suggested owner	Status	Owner (name)	Target date
RESILIENCE AND EXIT							
13.10	Business continuity covering Critical Operations and providers.	**Do BCPs name providers, and have joint tests been run?**	BCPs; test records	Operations	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.11	Contingency and exit plans, considering substitutability.	**Is there a tested exit plan for each critical provider?**	Exit plans; test dates	Business owners	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
13.12	The Central Bank may require discontinuation.	**Could you exit any critical arrangement in an orderly way?**	Off-boarding procedure	Business owners	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		
15.2–15.3	Notify incidents affecting Critical Operations: 4 h; summary 24 h; return to normal; high-risk 72 h.	**Could you notify the Central Bank within 4 hours today?**	Incident playbook; notification records	Operations, Compliance	☐ Not started ☐ In progress ☐ Done ☐ N/A		

REHEARSE IT

The 4-hour notification is the requirement most often found untested. Run a drill with one critical vendor this quarter.

READINESS SUMMARY

Score your readiness

Stage	Requirements	Not started	In progress	Done	N/A	Readiness %
Govern	5					
Select and contract	6					
Monitor	4					
Resilience and exit	4					
Total	**19**					

Readiness % = Done ÷ (Requirements − N/A). Record the reason for every N/A.

0–49%
Build
Start with the policy, the register and the Critical Operations map.

50–84%
Close the gaps
Prioritise contracts, exit plans and the 4-hour drill.

85–100%
Prove it
Test, sample and present evidence to the Board.

Requirements per stage



Total **19**

SIGN-OFF

Prepared by Name, role, date	
Reviewed by Second line	
Approved by Committee or Board, date	



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ABOUT NEXAPAIR

NexaPair is a third-party risk management platform for the UAE, hosted in a UAE cloud region. It verifies, screens, monitors and scores the companies an institution depends on, and keeps the evidence a regulator expects.

ABOUT KAYAK STRATEGIC ADVISORS

Kayak Strategic Advisors Private Limited (CIN U70200MH2026PTC477060) is a management consultancy based in Mumbai. It builds and runs NexaPair, pairing advisory judgement with software.

OFFICE
Mumbai, Maharashtra, India

EMAIL
advisory@kayaksa.com

PHONE
+91 7710 828 028

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